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TRACK A · AI FOUNDATIONS · KIT 6 OF 20

AI for Communication: Parent Messages, Translation, and Tone

Word-for-Word Facilitator Script: read it aloud exactly as written, or make it your own. Keyed to all 30 slides, with stage directions, a running clock, and answers to the questions staff actually ask.

Facilitator Script · 45–60 minutes

Built by Adam & Katelyn Spinozzi

A husband-and-wife team of certified educators with over 20 combined years in the classroom. Adam is a certified CTE Carpentry teacher; Katelyn is a certified K-8 teacher.

How to use this script

Everything in plain type is meant to be spoken aloud. Read it verbatim (it's written for the ear) or glance and paraphrase once you're comfortable. Either way delivers a complete session. Slide cues, stage directions, and question boxes work exactly as they did in Kits 1 through 5. Run Kits 1 and 2 before this one: today leans on Kit 1's privacy rules and Kit 2's prompt formula and voice round.

Meet Ms. Rivera. Throughout the deck you'll see the same example teacher's screen: Ms. Rivera, our running composite (not a real person; she appears in every kit). When her screen is up, point the room at it; it's the model to mimic in the lab. If someone asks who she is, say exactly that: a fictional teacher we use across the series so you always see what the work looks like before you try it yourself. Her tracker chip sits top-right on every slide; the matching line under each slide cue below tells you what it says, so you always know what the room is reading.

THE STANCE OF THIS WHOLE SESSION

AI drafts the message; you make it yours. Families hear you, not the tool. Every message is reviewed and personalized before it sends, and hard news is never delivered by a draft: you call.

Timing checkpoints

Clock	You should be...	If behind...
0:12	Starting the makeovers (slide 9)	Trim discussion on slides 5–7
0:24	On tone repair (slide 15)	Never trim slides 13–14 or 16; trim slide 12 instead
0:30	Starting the lab (slide 18)	Start it anyway; the lab is the session
0:54	On First 48 Hours (slide 28)	Hold the closing lines; hand out sheets at the door

45-minute version: run two diagnosis calls on slide 12 instead of four, skip lab step 3 (the note batch moves to the First 48 Hours sheet), take two share-out voices, and read the "45-min cut" stage notes where they appear.

From the founders

→ This note is from Adam and Katelyn Spinozzi, the two certified teachers who wrote this kit. It's here to give you their perspective before you present. Sharing it is entirely your call: read parts aloud where they fit, retell them in your own words, or keep it to yourself as background. The session is complete either way.

We're Adam and Katelyn, and here is why this session matters for what happens in your classrooms: family communication is where trust is built or lost, and it lives almost entirely in teachers' unpaid margins. The research is blunt about the stakes: even one personal sentence home per week measurably changes what happens for kids. But the messages that matter most are the ones teachers have the least time to write, and the families who most need reaching are often the ones our English-only messages never reach at all. AI can widen that doorway, on one condition: the voice that comes through it stays yours.

The lessons we believe this hour will leave with your staff: how to draft family messages in minutes instead of evenings and still sound like themselves; how to make the positive note home a weekly habit instead of a good intention; how to use translation support to reach every family while official news travels district channels; and the line that keeps all of it human, that hard news is delivered by a person, by voice, every time. Trust is built one reviewed, personal message at a time. This hour buys the time; the trust stays yours to earn.

Segment 1 · Welcome & why messages matter (slides 1–4)

SLIDE 1 Title

0:00

→ Slide 1 up as people arrive. Start on time.

Welcome back. Today is about the part of teaching nobody trained us for and everybody gets judged on: what we send home. Newsletters, updates, the email you rewrite four times because the first three sounded wrong. By the end of this hour, next week's real message will be drafted and sounding like you, you'll have a positive-note habit started, and every family on your roster, in every language your roster speaks, will be closer to actually hearing from you. That's the hour.

SLIDE 2 The margin problem

0:01

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her math: one wave of messages a week, drafted in the margins after dinner.

First the honest picture. Teachers work about 54 hours a week, and less than half of it is direct teaching; the rest is where communication lives, usually in the after-dinner margins. And teachers who've made AI a weekly habit report saving nearly six hours a week, with drafting communication among the most common uses. So the time is real and recoverable. The question of this session is how to recover it without families noticing a robot moved in.

SLIDE 3 One sentence moves the needle

0:03

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her lever: one sentence home per week moved real outcomes. She wants that at scale.

Now the reason this hour matters beyond your inbox. In a field experiment, Harvard researchers Kraft and Rogers had teachers send one individualized sentence home per week in a credit-recovery program. One sentence. The share of students failing to earn credit fell from about 16 percent to about 9 percent, a 41 percent reduction, and the biggest effects came from messages about what the student could improve. One personal sentence, once a week. The barrier was never that teachers didn't care; it was that personal-at-scale cost hours nobody had. That's exactly the cost AI just changed.

SLIDE 4 Agenda + one promise

0:04

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her goal: next week's real message drafted, a positive-note batch, a translation plan.

The hour: what AI is genuinely good at in family communication and the one thing it threatens, your voice. Then three makeovers on Ms. Rivera's screen: the newsletter, the difficult email, and the positive-note batch. Then the part most PD never touches: reaching the families our English-only messages miss, responsibly. Then the lab: you draft next week's real message, run the tone and reading-level passes, start your note batch, and write a translation plan for your actual roster. That's the promise: you leave with real messages ready to send, not notes about messages.

Segment 2 · The tool and the voice (slides 5–8)

SLIDE 5 What it's good at here

0:05

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her shortlist: newsletters, updates, tone repair, reading level, reformatting.

Where the intern earns its keep in communication: first drafts of anything routine, newsletters, updates, reminders; repairing tone when you're too tired or too angry to find it yourself; adjusting reading level so a message lands for every family; and reformatting, the same update as an email, a text blurb, and a printable flyer. Notice what's not on the list: anything that requires knowing the family. That part was never draftable.

SLIDE 6 The voice problem

0:07

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her worry, named: if every note sounds like every other note, families notice.

Now the threat, named honestly. AI output has a house style: smooth, pleasant, beige. In a lesson plan, beige is fine. In a message to a family who knows you, beige is noticeable, and across a school it compounds: if every teacher's newsletter sounds like the same cheerful robot, families stop reading all of them. Your voice, the slightly imperfect, recognizable, human one, is not a flaw to polish out. It's the asset. Kit 2's voice round is about to become the most important skill in this session.

SLIDE 7 The two rules ride along

0:09

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her two rules, still on: the situation, never the child; nothing goes out unread.

The permanent rules, pointed at communication. Rule one, from Kit 1: no student personally identifiable information in a public AI tool, and family communication is where the temptation is strongest, because the message IS about a specific child. The move is the same as always: describe the situation to the tool, "a middle schooler with several missing assignments," and add the name after the draft is back in your own email. Rule two: nothing AI-drafted reaches a family unread. Your name is on it; a family can't tell what you wrote from what you approved, and they shouldn't have to.

SLIDE 8 The banner

0:11

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her banner: families hear HER, not the tool.

So here's the banner over everything today: families hear you, not the tool. AI drafts; you review, personalize, and send. If a message wouldn't survive you reading it aloud in your own voice at a conference, it isn't done. Hold that; every technique in the next twenty minutes serves it.

Segment 3 · Three makeovers (slides 9–12)

SLIDE 9 Makeover #1: the newsletter

0:12

Makeover one, on Ms. Rivera's screen, and count the four parts with me: role in teal, a warm, organized teacher. Task in navy: this week's family newsletter. Context in amber, and look how much she gives it: the fractions unit wrapped, science fair Thursday at six in the gym, picture day Friday, blue permission slip due Wednesday. Format in green: under 150 words, skimmable on a phone, action items bulleted, one positive line about the class's week. That's Kit 2's formula doing family work. Ninety seconds of typing, and the draft comes back needing only her voice pass.

SLIDE 10 Makeover #2: the difficult email

0:15

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her difficult email: vent draft deleted, professional draft sent, relationship intact.

Makeover two: the email you shouldn't send. A parent emails something unfair at 9 p.m. and your first draft is honest in exactly the way careers end. Here's the move: let the tool absorb the heat. Describe the situation, no names: "Draft a calm, professional reply to a frustrated parent who believes their child's grade is unfair. Acknowledge the frustration, explain that specifics belong in a conversation, offer two meeting times, keep it under 120 words, firm and warm." The draft comes back with the emotion out and the relationship intact. You add the specifics in your own email, where names are safe. And the companion habit, the 24-hour rule: if the message made you angry, the reply waits a day unless safety can't. No AI needed for that one; it's just wisdom with a timestamp.

SLIDE 11 Makeover #3: the positive-note batch

0:18

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her batch: three one-sentence positive notes, each personalized before sending.

Makeover three is the Kraft and Rogers finding turned into a habit. The highest-leverage message in the research is one individualized sentence, and the version focused on what a student can improve moved outcomes most. So: the batch. Once a week, ask the tool for a page of one-sentence note starters, improvement-focused and warm, organized by situation: "showed persistence on a hard problem," "helped a classmate unprompted," "turned a rough Monday around." No names anywhere near the tool. Then you spend five minutes matching starters to real kids, personalizing each one in your own words, in your own email. The tool made the blank page cheap; the sentence that lands is still yours.

SLIDE 12 Practice: diagnose the message

0:21

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her diagnosis eye: no audience, no action item, buried lede. Now she can fix all three.

→ *Interactive. Read each sample, let the room call the problem, confirm with the answer strip at the bottom of the slide. 45-min cut: samples 1 and 3 only.*

Quick practice: what's wrong with each of these, as a family would read it? One: a 400-word newsletter where the field-trip permission slip is mentioned in the last paragraph. (Buried lede; the action item leads.) Two: a note written at a reading level that assumes everyone parses teacher jargon, "formative assessment data indicates." (Audience miss; families skim on phones, plain words win.) Three: a message with three updates and no clear thing to do. (No action item; every message ends with what to do, by when.) Four: a perfectly polished email that sounds like a bank wrote it. (Voice; warm it up before it goes out.) Your Cookbook of fixes is the same four prompts every time: shorter, plainer, lead with the action, sound like me.

Segment 4 · Reaching every family (slides 13–17)

SLIDE 13 The access gap

0:24

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her roster: several families who read other languages. Access is the assignment.

Now the families our messages never reach. One in ten public school students in this country, 5.3 million kids, is an English learner, and behind many of them is a family that reads a language our newsletters aren't written in. This isn't just a kindness gap; it's an obligation. Federal civil-rights guidance is explicit: schools must communicate with limited-English-proficient parents in a language they can understand, the same information other families get. Every English-only newsletter quietly leaves families out of the conversation the research just told us changes outcomes.

SLIDE 14 Translation, responsibly

0:26

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her translation plan: plain language first, district channel for official, human check.

Here's the responsible way to use AI translation support, four rules. One: draft in plain language first, short sentences, no idioms; plain English translates well, clever English translates badly. Two: official and legal documents, anything about rights, discipline, or special education, go through your district's translation channel, not your chatbot; that's their lane and their obligation. Three: for your routine classroom messages, AI translation is a real access win, and when the stakes rise, get a human check from a bilingual colleague, aide, or district liaison; helpful and imperfect is the honest description of machine translation. Four: the privacy rule doesn't take a language off, no student details in a public tool in any language. Do those four and your reach just grew by every family on your roster.

SLIDE 15 The tone-repair kit

0:28

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her tone kit: 'warmer, shorter, plainer,' the read-aloud test, the 24-hour rule.

The tone-repair kit, small enough to memorize. Three commands fix ninety percent of drafts: warmer, shorter, plainer. One test catches the rest: read it aloud; your ear knows your voice better than your eyes do. And one rule protects your career: the 24-hour rule for anything written angry. That's the whole kit. It fits on the handout's back pocket and it will save you a hundred small regrets a year.

SLIDE 16 The human-only list

0:29

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her human-only list: safety, discipline, grief, IEP news. She calls first.

And the line that never moves. Some news is never delivered by a draft: anything touching a child's safety, a serious discipline situation, a family's grief, or special-education decisions. For those, the technology is a telephone and the script is your own heart, first. A written follow-up can come later, and even then you write it yourself. If a message would change how a family sees their child, it deserves a human voice. No exceptions, and say so out loud to your staff, because this is the line that makes all the efficiency defensible.

SLIDE 17 What this builds

0:30

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her trust ledger: every reviewed, personal message is a deposit.

One beat on what all this builds. Every message home is a deposit in or a withdrawal from the only account that matters when something goes wrong: trust. Reviewed, personal, on-time messages, in a language the family reads, are deposits. Late, generic, robotic ones are withdrawals. AI just made deposits cheap. The lab starts now.

Segment 5 · The lab: real messages (slides 18–23)

SLIDE 18 Lab setup

0:30

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her lab plan: one real message, one note batch, one translation plan.

→ *Dark slide. Devices out, pairs formed inside two minutes. Announce the tool.*

Lab time, nineteen minutes, three deliverables, all real. One: next week's actual message to families, drafted and voiced. Two: your first positive-note batch. Three: a translation access plan for your actual roster. Ground rules: no student information of any kind, no family names; describe situations, never people. Pair up; every message gets a second set of ears before it counts as done. Go.

SLIDE 19 Lab step 1: draft the real message

0:32

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR On her screen: next week's message, drafted with all four parts.

→ 6 minutes. Circulate. Weak drafts lack context; nudge with "what does a family actually need to know and do this week?"

Step one, six minutes: the message you actually owe families this week or next. Newsletter, unit update, event reminder, whatever is real. All four parts, and be generous with context: what happened, what's coming, what families need to do and by when. Mimic the shape on Ms. Rivera's screen from slide 9. Run it. Read it as a tired parent on a phone at 9 p.m., because that's who's reading it.

SLIDE 20 Lab step 2: the two passes

0:38

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her passes: tone (sounds like her) and reading level (skimmable on a phone).

→ 5 minutes. Pairs read each other's drafts **ALoud**; the partner's ear is the voice test.

Step two, five minutes, two passes. The voice pass: read your draft aloud to your partner. If it doesn't sound like you, fix it with the kit: warmer, shorter, plainer, or just retype the sentence the way you'd say it. The access pass: is it skimmable, plain words, action item up top with a date? When both passes pass, that message is done and genuinely ready to send this week.

SLIDE 21 Lab step 3: start the batch

0:43

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her batch, live: three improvement-focused notes, names added only in her own email.

→ 5 minutes. 45-min cut: skip this step; it moves to the First 48 Hours sheet.

Step three, five minutes: the batch. Ask for one-sentence positive-note starters, improvement-focused and warm, by situation, no names. Pick three, and match each to a real student in your head. Personalize them later today in your own email, where names belong. Three families are about to get the sentence the research says matters, and it cost you five minutes.

SLIDE 22 Lab step 4: the access plan

0:48

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her access plan: which languages, which channel, who gives the human check.

→ 3 minutes, quiet writing. The handout has the three-line plan template.

Last step, three minutes, alone: the access plan for your roster. Three lines on the handout: which languages your families read; which channel carries official documents, that's the district's translation lane; and who gives your routine translated messages a human check when stakes rise. If you don't know the languages on your roster, that's the plan's first line: find out this week.

SLIDE 23 Share-out

0:51

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her share-out: the before and after, read aloud.

→ 3 voices, one minute each. 45-min cut: two voices.

Three voices, a minute each: read us a before and after, or your favorite note starter. Listen for how different the voices sound; that's the whole point. Same tool, thirty different teachers, thirty recognizable humans.

Segment 6 · Making it stick (slides 24–27)

SLIDE 24 What you just built

0:52

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her inventory: message ready, batch started, translation plan written.

The inventory, twenty minutes of work: a real message to families, voiced and ready for this week. A positive-note batch with three families' sentences chosen. And an access plan that starts reaching the families English-only messages missed. That last one might matter most, and it took three minutes.

SLIDE 25 Honest limits

0:53

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her honest limits: AI can't know the family or repair trust it didn't build.

Honest limits, as always. The tool doesn't know your families, their histories, or what last year did to their trust in schools; you do, and personalizing is where that knowledge enters. Machine translation is helpful and imperfect; that's why the human check exists. And no tool repairs trust; only consistency does. AI lowers the cost of consistency. That's its whole contribution, and it's a big one.

SLIDE 26 Our three commitments

0:54

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her commitments: review and personalize everything; call first on hard news; one batch a week.

Three commitments, same drill as every kit. One: every AI-drafted message is reviewed and personalized before it sends; families hear me, not the tool. Two: hard news travels by voice first, mine, every time. Three: one positive-note batch a week; the one-sentence habit the research validated. Can I get a nod on those three?

SLIDE 27 Where this goes

0:55

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her month: batch habit, translation audit, comms templates in the staff doc.

The month ahead, all inside existing PLC time: week two, a batch check-in, who sent their three notes and what came back; week three, the translation audit, every team knows its roster's languages and channels; week four, the best message templates go in the staff doc's new Communication section. Nobody at this school writes the field-trip reminder from scratch again.

Close (slides 28–30)

SLIDE 28 First 48 hours

0:55

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her 48 hours: send the message, send the batch, start the access plan.

First 48 Hours sheet, three actions: send the message you drafted today, it's done, let it be done; personalize and send your three positive notes; and take the first step of your access plan, even if it's just learning which languages your families read. Three sends, and this PD becomes something families actually felt.

SLIDE 29 Exit ticket

0:56

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her exit ticket: what she drafted, her note-batch plan, one worry.

Exit tickets at the door: what you drafted, your note-batch plan, and the communication situation you still want help with. Those situations set the agenda for the follow-ups, so be specific.

SLIDE 30 Close

0:56

Last word. Nobody remembers a beige newsletter, and nobody forgets the teacher who sent home one true sentence about their kid. The tool writes drafts now. The sentences families keep are still yours. Next session, Kit 7, we go after the workload itself: finding each of you the best saved hour in your week. Thanks for the hour. Go send something worth keeping.

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